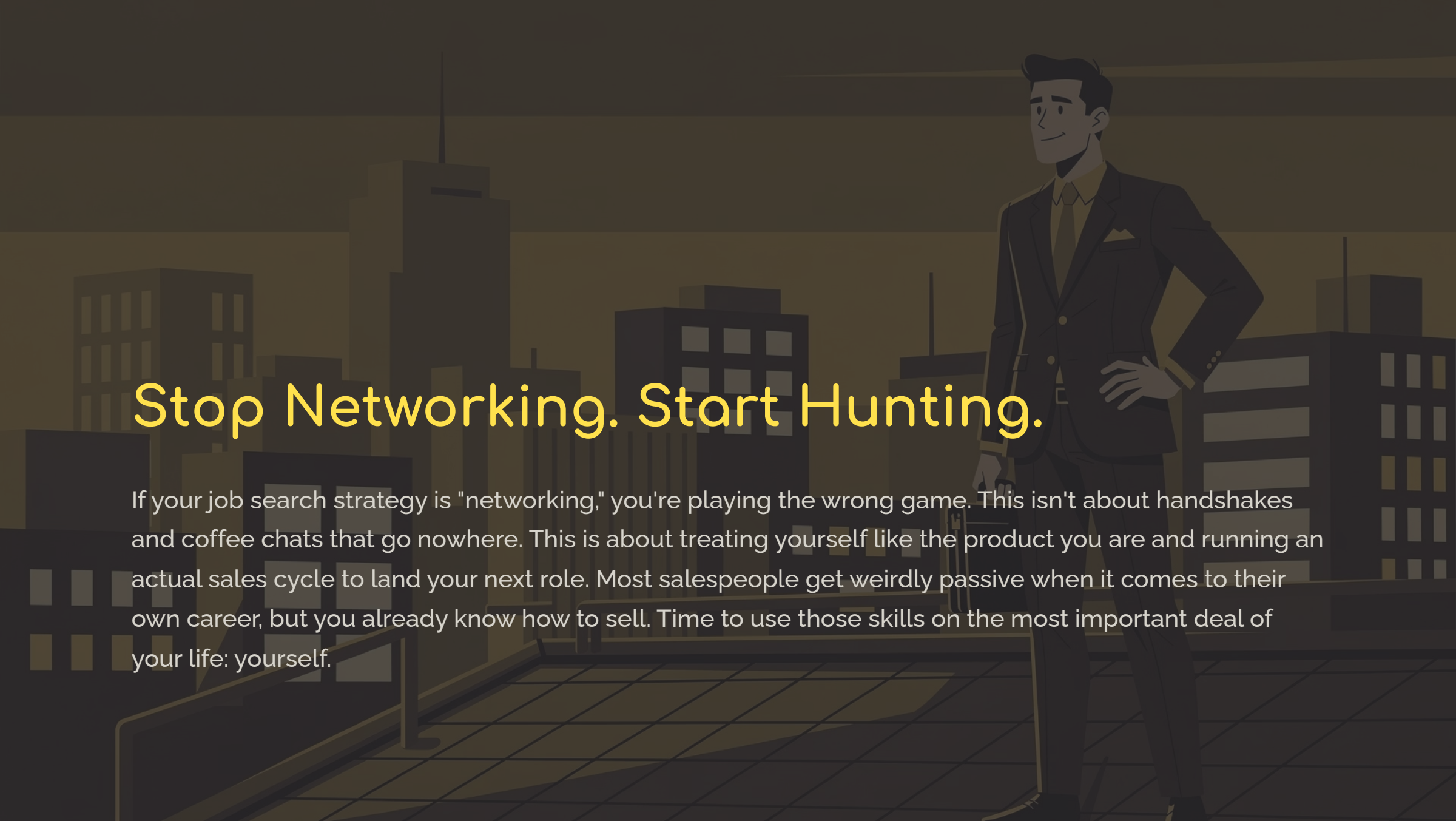


A stylized illustration of a man in a dark suit and tie standing on a rooftop at night. He is looking off to the side with a slight smile, his left hand on his hip and his right hand holding a briefcase. The background features a city skyline with various buildings and a grid-like pattern on the rooftop floor.

Stop Networking. Start Hunting.

If your job search strategy is "networking," you're playing the wrong game. This isn't about handshakes and coffee chats that go nowhere. This is about treating yourself like the product you are and running an actual sales cycle to land your next role. Most salespeople get weirdly passive when it comes to their own career, but you already know how to sell. Time to use those skills on the most important deal of your life: yourself.

Things to Know.

The Reality

The ATS is a black hole. Recruiters might be rejecting you, but there's no way they're reviewing all applications. Unless you're a 100% slam dunk, you're not getting called. Passive networking doesn't create urgency when you need a job in 30-60 days.

Here's what most people don't want to admit: you're comfortable being aggressive when selling your product, but you get passive and polite about your career. You worry about seeming desperate or pushy. Get over it. You're not desperate—you're conducting a strategic job search using the exact methodology that made you successful as a seller in the first place.

What Actually Works

Treating your job search like an active sales cycle. You research accounts, find multiple entry points, build champions, create urgency, and demonstrate value before asking for the close. Stop waiting for permission. Start hunting.

You Are The Product. Act Like It.

01

Identify Your ICP

Pick 10-15 companies where you'd actually want to work. Focus on organizations whose values align with yours and where your skills create maximum impact.

03

Multi-Thread Like a Pro

Don't single-thread your job search. Start with AEs on the team, gather intel, build advocates, then move upmarket to the VP or CRO with context and credibility.

Apollo will run you about \$100 a month—less than most people spend on networking lunches that lead nowhere. This isn't about gaming the system. It's about applying the same rigor to your job search that you apply to your deals. You wouldn't single-thread a major account in your territory. Don't single-thread your career.

02

Build Your Pipeline

Get a data intelligence platform like Apollo or ZoomInfo. Find hiring managers, VPs of Sales, and current AEs. Get their cell numbers and direct emails—the info you need to reach decision makers.

04

Create Urgency

Reference your conversations with team members. Demonstrate you've done homework. Show you're serious about this specific opportunity. Make them want to move fast before they lose you.

Multi-Threading: Your Secret Weapon

Start with the AEs on the team you want to join. Not the manager. Not the CRO. The people actually doing the job. Reach out with genuine curiosity about team structure, sales process, what's working, what's challenging. These conversations give you intelligence about the role, help you identify champions, and provide specific talking points when you reach the hiring manager.



Research Current AEs

Find 2-3 reps on the team.
Study their backgrounds and recent wins.



Run Discovery

Ask about challenges, team dynamics, and what success looks like.



Move Upmarket

Reach out to VP/CRO with context from your conversations. You're not cold anymore.

Once you've talked to people on the team, you're not coming in cold to leadership. You're coming in with context, with names, with specific intelligence about their challenges. You're demonstrating that you're serious, thorough, and already thinking like someone who belongs on their team. That's how you create urgency. That's how you differentiate. That's how you close.

Why You're Falling Short.

You got the meeting. You've multi-threaded your approach. Now you're sitting in the interview, and this is where most people absolutely fuck it up. Because getting the meeting is only half the battle. The other half is proving—beyond any doubt—that you're not just qualified, but that you're the best person for this specific role. And that requires more than saying "I hit my number."

"Everyone says they hit their number. Everyone claims relationships are their superpower. If you're saying what everyone else says, you're not differentiated. You're just noise."



The Problem: Everyone Says The Same Shit

What Everyone Says

- "I hit my number"
- "I exceeded expectations"
- "My biggest strength is relationships"
- "I'm passionate about sales"
- "I'm a team player with strong communication skills"

These are table stakes. They get you in the door but don't close the deal. Hiring managers hear this 50 times a week.

What Actually Works

- Specific methodology behind your success
- Quantified outcomes with context
- Systems you've built that others haven't
- Framework for how you operate
- Evidence of what makes you different

This is proof. This is what separates quota-hitters from quota-crushers.

Build Your Proof of Concept

Don't tell hiring managers you're great at relationships. Show them WHY you're great at relationships. What do you actually do differently than everyone else? How do you develop relationships in a way that creates measurable business outcomes? There's a specific way you operate—a pattern, a method, a discipline. That's what they want to hear.

The Wrong Way

"I'm really good at building relationships and that's why I consistently hit quota."

The Right Way

"I'm effective at building relationships because I do three things consistently: First, I research every prospect's last three LinkedIn posts before our first call so I can open with something relevant to them personally. Second, I send a voice note recap after every meeting because it adds a human touch nobody else is doing. Third, I set a reminder to check in 90 days after close when clients are forming renewal opinions."

See the difference? That's not a vague claim. That's a system. That's proof. That's something a hiring manager can visualize you doing in their organization. You don't have a magic keyboard or magic cell phone. You have a specific methodology that produces results. Document it. Practice it. Own it.

The Work Nobody Wants To Do

1 Dissect Yourself

If you say you're great at discovery, what does that actually mean? What questions do you ask that others don't? What framework are you using? Get specific.

2 Quantify Everything

What's your close rate compared to peers? What specific techniques do you use in final stages? What's your conversion rate at each pipeline stage?

3 Rebuild Your Story

Take those specifics and create a narrative around 2-3 real examples that demonstrate your differentiator in action. Make it concrete and credible.

4 Practice Until Natural

Rehearse your stories until they sound conversational, not scripted. Anticipate objections and prepare responses that reinforce your differentiator.

Most people don't want to do this work. It's easier to lean on generic talking points and hope personality carries you through. But that's not how you get hired in a competitive market. You have to poke holes in your own story, ask the hard questions, then rebuild with precision. The candidates who get hired aren't lucky. They've done the work.

Use AI To Become Dangerous

Before AI, deep research on a hiring manager required reading through dozens of LinkedIn posts, listening to podcast appearances, and cross-referencing career moves across platforms. That took hours. Now? Paste a LinkedIn URL into Claude or ChatGPT and ask it to tell you everything. This takes 60 seconds and gives you hours worth of intelligence.

60

Seconds

Time it takes AI to analyze
someone's entire professional
presence

10-15

Targets

Focus on this many leaders
you'd actually want to work with

99%

Of Candidates

Send generic outreach. Be in the
1% who actually did homework.

The AI Research Process

Here's the exact process I use to research any hiring manager or VP of Sales in under 60 seconds. This isn't creepy stalker behavior—this is becoming genuinely informed so you can have an actual conversation instead of pitching into the void.

The Claude Prompt

"Who is [Name]? Give me a comprehensive profile by pulling from LinkedIn, podcasts, YouTube interviews, articles, and any other public content. I want to understand: their career trajectory, sales philosophy, leadership style, what they're building at their current company, and any specific hooks or insights that would grab their attention in an outreach message."

Within 60 seconds, you'll have their career journey, leadership philosophy, what they value in team members, their entrepreneurial background if they have one, current company focus, and specific hooks that would grab their attention. This is all public information they WANT people to know. They went on podcasts. They write LinkedIn posts. They're building a professional brand specifically so people can discover this stuff.

Professional Research vs. Creepy Stalker Shit

✓ Fair Game

- LinkedIn posts and articles
- Podcast appearances
- Conference talks
- YouTube interviews
- Company blogs
- Professional Twitter threads

The Rule: If they created it professionally to be discovered, use it.

✗ Stay Away From

- Personal Instagram
- Family photos
- Vacation pictures
- Where they live
- Relationship status
- Kids' names

The Test: Would this naturally come up at a conference? If no, don't mention it.

When a VP goes on a podcast or writes a LinkedIn post, they're creating permission for you to reference it. That's the whole point of building a professional brand. Most sales leaders are literally begging you to pay attention to their content. Just don't be weird about it. Only reference professional content, never personal life details.

What AI-Powered Outreach Actually Looks Like

Here's the difference between generic outreach that gets ignored and research-backed outreach that gets responses. These examples show you exactly how to use the intelligence AI gives you to write messages that stand out.

Generic Garbage

"Hi, I'm a sales professional with 5+ years of experience in SaaS. I'm very interested in opportunities at your company and would love to connect. I'm passionate about sales and have consistently exceeded quota. Would you be available for a quick call?"

Could be sent to literally anyone. Zero personalization. Instantly forgettable.

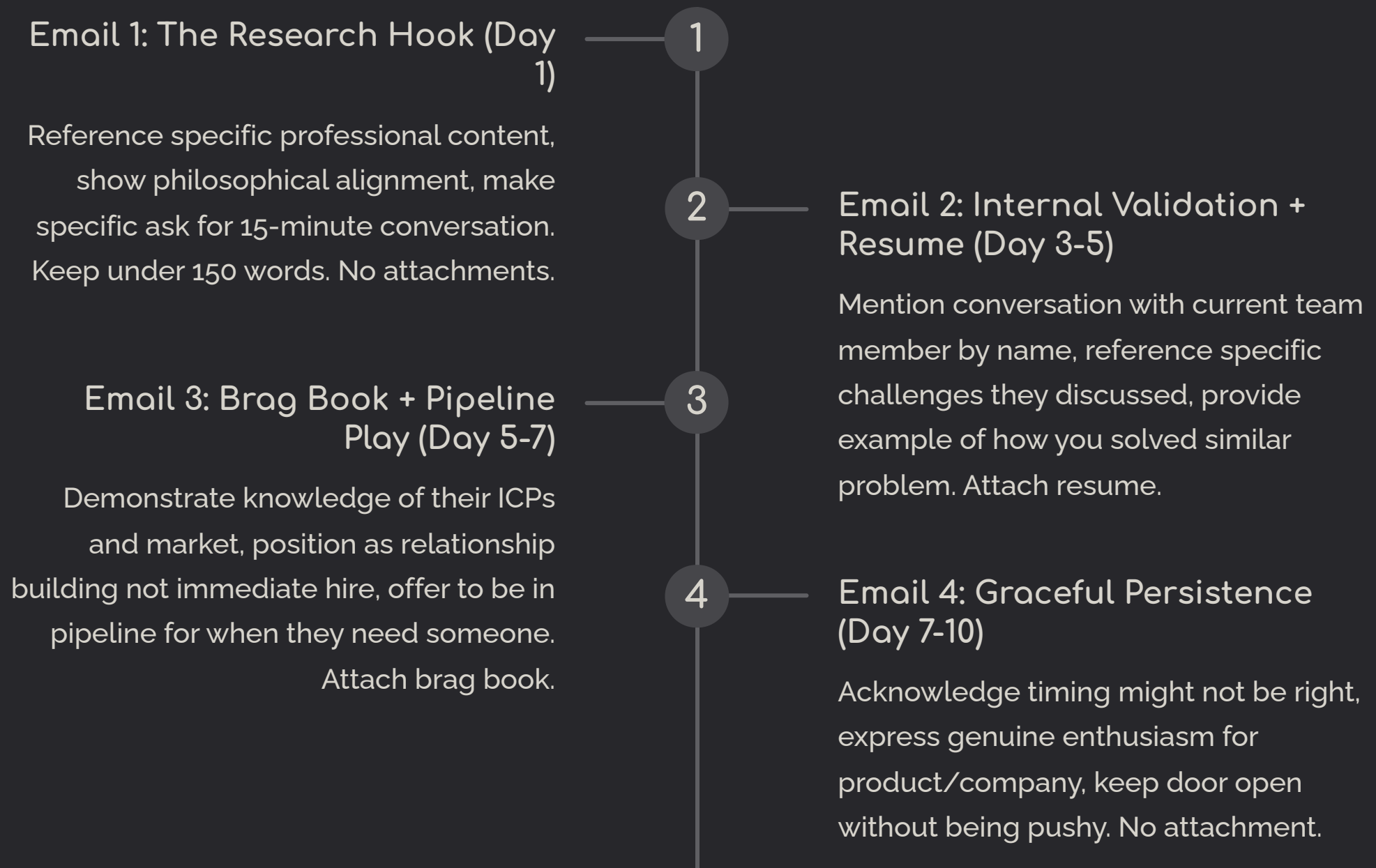
Research-Backed Winner

"Hey Mike, Saw 'Extreme Ownership' leading your LinkedIn headline. Not typical VP language. Started as a BDR at [Company], now running a team of 8. Hit 127% last year. What caught my attention: You started as BDR, built ThreadHeart to \$100K in 9 months, and talk about personalizing quotas. That's not cookie-cutter thinking. Would love 15 minutes to discuss what you're building and how you think about bringing people onto your team."

References specific philosophy, career path, and unique approaches. Shows you actually did homework.

The 4-Email Job Search Sequence

Most people send one email and give up. Smart candidates run a structured sequence that builds credibility with each touchpoint. This isn't spam—it's strategic persistence that demonstrates you're serious. Here's the exact sequence that gets responses.



Space these emails out properly. Don't blast them all in one week. Give each email 5-7 days to breathe. After Email 4, move to quarterly check-ins unless they respond. Track everything in a spreadsheet like a sales pipeline, because that's exactly what it is.

Your Brag Book: The Secret Weapon

I've placed hundreds of enterprise reps over the years. The ones who land the best gigs? They don't just have a resume—they have receipts. A Brag Book is a detailed, storytelling document that shows hiring managers exactly how you hunt, how you think, and how you recover when things go sideways. Most sellers think President's Club speaks for itself. It doesn't.



Major Wins

3-5 detailed deal stories with company, buyer, timeline, and exact strategy you used to close. Include dollar amounts and key moves that made the difference.



Losses & Lessons

2-3 deals you lost with complete honesty about what went wrong and what you learned. This shows self-awareness and growth—qualities every VP wants.



References & Recognition

Quotes from former managers, customers, and executives who can vouch for your work. Include awards, President's Club wins, and quota attainment numbers.

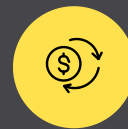
Building Your Brag Book: Major Wins

Your major wins section should tell complete stories, not just list achievements. Here's the structure that works: Company and buyer context, timeline and source, the complete story with challenges and your approach, specific moves that made the difference, and measurable outcomes. Don't just say you closed a \$500K deal—explain HOW you did it in a way that proves you can do it again.



The Setup

Company size, buyer role, deal size, and how you sourced it. Give context for why this was significant.



The Story

Walk through the sales process. What was their pain? How did you build relationships? What obstacles came up?



Key Moves

Specific tactics you used that others might not have thought of. This is what differentiates you.



The Outcome

Dollar amount, contract terms, and what happened after. Expansions, referrals, other wins that resulted.

Remember: You're not bragging. You're providing evidence that you can execute at a high level. Hiring managers want to see exactly how you operate in real situations. Give them the story behind the numbers, and they'll be able to visualize you doing the same thing on their team.

The Power of Documented Losses

Here's what nobody wants to talk about: your losses might be more valuable than your wins. Every VP of Sales wants to know—how do you handle failure? What do you learn from it? Do you make the same mistakes twice? Including 2-3 detailed loss stories in your Brag Book demonstrates self-awareness, accountability, and growth. These aren't about making excuses. They're about showing you treat every loss like graduate school.

What To Include In Loss Stories

- The deal details and where it fell apart
- Complete honesty about what you did wrong
- Specific lesson learned and how you've changed your approach
- Evidence you haven't made that mistake again

"If you're losing on price, you lost in discovery. I didn't build enough value early enough. Now I establish ROI and business impact in the first two calls, not during negotiations. I also learned that chasing deals with discount-first buyers is a waste of time."

That's the kind of insight hiring managers want to see. Not excuses. Not blame. Just honest reflection and proof that you've evolved. The reps who land the best roles aren't the ones who pretend they never lose. They're the ones who learn from losses faster than anyone else.



Stop Playing The Lottery. Start Playing Chess.

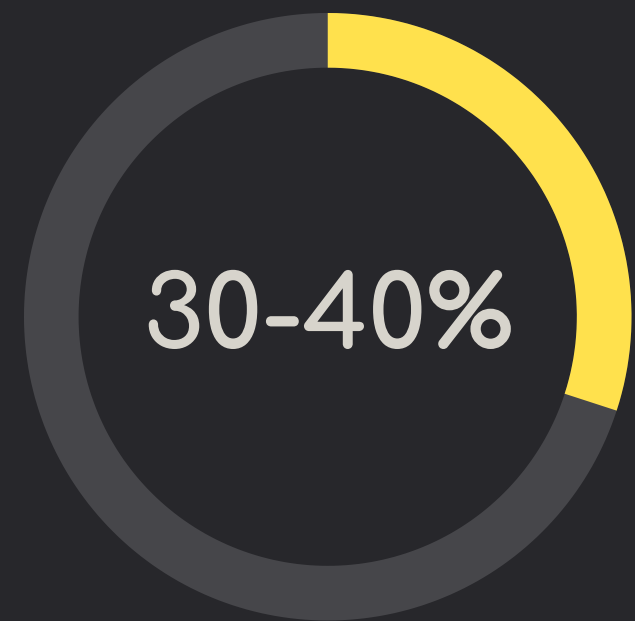
Most people are playing the lottery with their job search. They blast 500 applications or send 200 generic emails, cross their fingers, and hope something sticks. It's exhausting, inefficient, and it doesn't work. Smart people are playing chess. They identify exactly who they want to work with, research the hell out of them using AI, and show up like they already belong in the conversation.



Applications most people send
hoping for 1-2 responses



Strategic targets smart
candidates focus on intensely



Response rate when you do
proper research and
personalization

You're not competing with 500 applicants anymore. You're competing with the 5 people who actually did their homework. Be one of the 5. Stop acting like your job search is some special category where your sales skills don't apply. You're in a sales cycle. You're the product. Treat it that way from pipeline to research to close.

The Complete Job Search System



Build Your Data Infrastructure

Get Apollo, ZoomInfo, or similar tool. Invest \$100/month to access decision makers directly instead of throwing resumes into the ATS void.



Identify & Research Targets

Pick 10-15 companies and leaders you'd actually want to work with. Use AI to research each target deeply—60 seconds per person for hours of intelligence.



Multi-Thread Your Approach

Start with current AEs on the team, gather intel, build advocates, then move upmarket to VPs with context and credibility behind you.



Run The Email Sequence

Execute the 4-email sequence over 2-3 weeks. Research hook, internal validation with resume, brag book with pipeline play, graceful persistence.



Build Your Proof Points

Create your Brag Book with detailed win stories, honest loss stories, and strong references. Practice articulating your differentiator until it sounds natural.



Close Like You Sell

Show up to interviews with specific methodology, quantified outcomes, and evidence of what makes you irreplaceable. Prove you're the best, not just better.

The Bottom Line: Take The Bull By The Horns

Look, the job market is tough right now. Lots of good salespeople competing for fewer roles. The traditional advice—optimize your LinkedIn, apply online, ask for introductions— isn't cutting it. But you have an advantage most job seekers don't: you already know how to sell. You understand pipeline management, multi-threading, qualification, urgency creation, and closing.

The problem is most people only apply those skills to getting the meeting. They forget that the interview itself is the close. And they send the same generic outreach everyone else sends. You need all three pieces: the process to get in front of decision makers, the precision to differentiate yourself once you're there, and the research to make your outreach actually stand out.

Stop Networking Start treating your job search like an actual sales cycle with pipeline, multi-threading, and strategic account planning.	Build Proof Create a Brag Book that shows exactly how you operate, what you've achieved, and what you learned from failures.
Use AI Research targets in 60 seconds instead of 60 minutes. Show up informed and ready to have real conversations.	Execute Run the system consistently. Track everything. Iterate based on results. Close the deal.

AI doesn't replace relationship-building. It accelerates it. You still need to write good messages, provide value, and be genuine. But when you can walk into conversations already knowing someone's philosophy, background, and what they care about, you're not playing the volume game anymore. You're one of the 5 people who actually did the homework.

Now Go Execute

Stop acting like your job search is some special category where your sales skills don't apply. You're in a sales cycle. You're the product. The hiring manager is the buyer. The role is the deal. And right now, you have everything you need to run the most effective pipeline of your career.

Put in the work. Build the pipeline. Research your targets using AI. Multi-thread your approach. Create your Brag Book with detailed stories. Differentiate yourself with specific methodology. Close the deal like you would any other.

Most people won't do this. They'll keep playing the lottery, sending generic applications, hoping for luck. That's your competitive advantage. Be one of the 5% who treats this like the professional seller you are.

That's what taking the bull by the horns actually looks like.

